EXHIBITIONS IN THE NEW YORK GALLERIES

MORRIS KANTOR
Rehn Galleries

Apart from the exhibition of paintings by Baylinson and Kantor held at Brummer's last season the present Rehn show is the first comprehensive display of Kantor's paintings. To say that it is a pleasant relief after the Carrol and Miller shows is small compliment and would be quite pointless except for the fact that the three shows have had a common setting and therefore invite comparison.

In the former shows, apart from matters of taste, the most disturbing elements were the painfully apparent efforts to erect modernistic structures on very shaky foundations. Attempts to be remarkable, for the sake of astounding the multitude, serve only to reveal a painter's deficiencies. Kantor's exhibition is peculiarly free from blatant gestures and, though it is possible that his gift is no greater than those of the other men, the simplicity and directness of his painting create a much finer impression. He seems very serious and quite unassuming and, although many of the paintings are rather unoriginal experiments in composition, he is neither a copyist nor a poseur.

The most appealing pictures in the show are those in which the literary approach is least stressed, the quite simple still lifes, the trees and harbors. In these he creates low-toned decoration, pleasant in texture and carefully ordered. The two nudes and the large figure of a Hindu woman are interesting chiefly as studies.

VERA M. WHITE
Ferargil Gallery

Water colors and oils by Vera M. White have been on exhibition at the Ferargil Galleries for the past two weeks. The show is the first which Mrs. White has had in New York although her pictures are well known in Philadelphia.

Throughout the exhibition the water colors were much more successful than the oils and the medium seems the one most suited to the painter's direct, clearly defined pictures. The majority of these make use of flowers as elements in well organized compositions.

J. CLINTON SHEPHERD
SAVA BOTZARIS
TENG-KWEI
JOSE DE CREEFT
Fifty-Sixth Street Galleries

That industrious beehive of artistic activities, the Fifty-Sixth Street Galleries, is at present host to Chinese, Greek, Spanish and one hundred per cent American talents. Mr. Sava Bótzaris, a Greek sculptor who has won considerable acclaim in recent London exhibitions, is the most interesting personality in the group. Although tactfully realizing that Sir John Lavery and Captain Ernest Duveen must have their features handled more circumspectly than Miss Edith Sitwell or G B S, the artist is as a whole delightfully undismayed by a distinguished clientele. Instead of smoothing over facial deficiencies and lending a specious nobility to all his sitters, he often plunges boldly into caricature, converting the quintessential Shaw into a slim Egyptian pedestal of turquoise blue, surmounted by a head of bearded wisdom and elongating the neck of Mr. Ernest Thesiger into super-swan like curves until he resembles a latter day Gothic angel. The more purely decorative works are less even in quality. Occasionally, in the quest of the unconventional, Mr. Bótzaris oversteps his mark, indulges in attenuations until they become almost a formula or gives way to certain mannerisms which are more dramatically effective than aesthetically sound. On the whole, however, the showing is an interesting one, in which technical skill and sly wit are happily united.

On the other hand, Mr. J. Clinton Shepherd, who is simultaneously exhibiting paintings and sculpture of the West, takes the great open spaces very seriously. The artist obviously knows horses and the men who ride them, has an intimate acquaintance with bronco twisters, "bulldoggers," "broom tails" and horse wranglers. His bronzes have the liveliness and movement which the material demands and from the purely anatomical point of view reveal considerable study of animals in action. The slight story telling element inherent in Mr. Shepherd's work will doubtless appeal to the many who still make their approach to art through subject appeal. The group of thirteen Western paintings by Mr. Shepherd are quite as realistic as the bronzes, but the local color is not reinforced by adequate technical equipment. In the handling of color especially, the artist appears far less experienced than in the modulation of bronze surfaces.

The group of Chinese paintings by Teng-Kwei, which hang in the same gallery with the sculptures of José de Creeft, are specially notable as a praiseworthy attempt to return to the great tradition of Oriental painting. The artist works with sepia ink and brush, doing landscapes, ducks, bamboo and water falls that spiritually, at least, hark back to the great masters of the past. That Teng-Kwei does not as yet command the exquisite delicacy of touch and vision that distinguished the earlier prototypes, is perhaps beside the point. In the general decadence of Chinese art, he is striving towards a worthy goal, which is most closely approached in a little painting of bamboo sprays, done with great economy and restraint.

The group of José de Creeft bronzes consists largely of work shown a few weeks ago at the Ferargil Galleries and reviewed at that time in the columns of The Art News. A second viewing of this sculptor's work once more reveals him as an artist highly sensitive to the modulations of many varying materials, but a trifle mannered and derivative in many of his designs.

PAINTINGS FROM MYSTIC
Macbeth Gallery

The third exhibition at the Macbeth Gallery of paintings from the summer colonies is devoted to a group from Mystic, Connecticut. The pictures were chosen from the colonists' annual show.

Most of the painters in this group are younger and less famous than those from Lyme or Gloucester but the general character of the show is not greatly different. All of the artists seem safely started on the road to the National Academy. The color throughout is fresh and pleasant and many of the canvases are cheerfully decorative.

STEWART MACDERMOTT
Milch Galleries

An unusually cheerful group of paintings by Stewart MacDermott appears to herald the conversion of the Milch Galleries to modernism in its milder forms. Landscapes, still lifes and two figure compositions make up the showing. Of these, the still lifes are both the most numerous and the most successful, although in a few instances the artist has marred his design by too great profusion of detail.

In his color harmonies and fondness for fabrics of oriental pattern, it is apparent that MacDermott is a disciple of Matisse, albeit a slightly timorous one. Except for two corn harvest subjects, the landscapes as a group fall considerably below the level of the still lifes. A single nude, though slightly overstressing patterns in wall hangings and rug, makes one hope that the artist may devote more of his energies in the future to figure painting.

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